THE FIRE MAN

FIRE SAFETY AND

Maintenance Logbook

Weekly, monthly and annual records for your fire alarm, emergency lighting, extinguishers and escape routes

Updated for BS 5839-1:2025 and BS 5266-1:2025

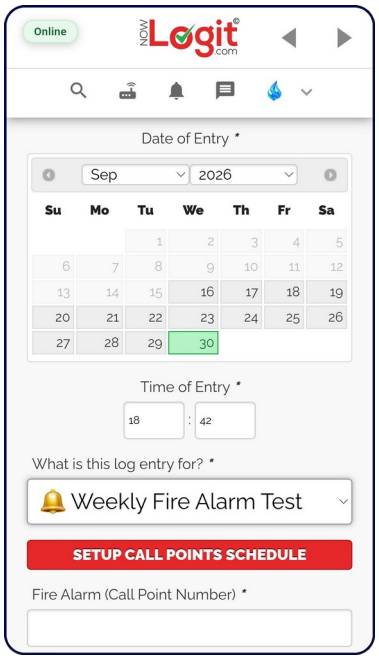
Premises	
Responsible person	
Logbook started	
Logbook finished	

Prefer to log online?

Scan the QR code on your fire panel to record tests with NowLogIt.

What's inside

Premises details · Fire risk assessment record · Fire drills · Escape routes and fire doors · Extinguisher checks · 52-week fire alarm test record · Emergency lighting tests · Faults and false alarms · Service visits · Training



Log tests on your phone with NowLogIt

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Keep this logbook somewhere safe, near the fire alarm panel. Show it to your service engineer and to the fire service on request.

START HERE

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How to use this logbook

- **Fill in the premises page first.** It tells anyone using the book what you have and who is in charge.
- **Test, then write it down straight away.** If it is not recorded, an inspector will treat it as not done.
- **Use the "How to" pages.** Each record has a simple guide just before it.
- **Report every fault.** Log it on the fault page and call your engineer. Note the date it was fixed.
- **Keep it for inspection.** The fire service, your insurer and your engineer may ask to see it.

> **Prefer to log online?**
> Scan the QR code on your fire panel to record tests with NowLogIt.

YOUR DUTIES

What the law asks of you

The rules below apply in England. Your fire risk assessment decides exactly what your premises need.

Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005	The "responsible person" (employer, owner, landlord or managing agent) must carry out a fire risk assessment, review it regularly, and keep fire safety equipment and escape routes maintained and in good working order.
Building Safety Act 2022, s.156 (from 1 Oct 2023)	Every responsible person must record the fire risk assessment in full, not just the significant findings, whatever the size of the business. Record your fire safety arrangements. Record the name (and company) of anyone who helps you assess. Only appoint an assessor who is competent. Share fire safety information with other responsible persons and, in residential buildings, with residents. Hand all records to any new responsible person.
Fire Safety Act 2021 (from 16 May 2022)	In buildings with two or more homes, the Fire Safety Order covers the structure, external walls (including windows and balconies) and flat entrance doors.
Fire Safety (England) Regulations 2022 (from 23 Jan 2023)	Blocks with two or more homes: give residents fire safety instructions and fire door information, and repeat it every year. Over 11 m high: check communal fire doors every 3 months and flat entrance doors every year (best endeavours).
HMO Management Regulations 2006 (England), reg. 4	HMO managers must keep escape routes clear and in good repair, and keep fire alarms and firefighting equipment in good working order.

The British Standards behind your checks

Standards are codes of practice, not law. Following them is the usual way to show your equipment is properly maintained.

Equipment	Standard	What it means for you
Fire alarms (non-domestic)	**BS 5839-1:2025**	Weekly call point test by you. Service by a competent person about every 6 months. All agreed variations recorded in the logbook. Every false alarm investigated.
Fire alarms (homes and HMOs)	**BS 5839-6:2019+A1:2020**	Grade A panel systems: weekly test and 6-monthly service, as BS 5839-1. Grade D smoke alarms: press the test button at least monthly.
Emergency lighting	**BS 5266-1:2025 and BS EN 50172:2024**	Monthly short functional test. Annual full rated-duration test. Results kept in a logbook.
Fire extinguishers (maintenance)	**BS 5306-3:2017**	Monthly visual check by you. Annual basic service by a competent person. Extended service every 5 years (CO_2: overhaul every 10 years).
Fire extinguishers (choice and siting)	**BS 5306-8:2023**	The right type for the risk, in the right place, easy to reach.

What an inspector may ask to see

- Your fire risk assessment, recorded in full, with the assessor's name.
- Your fire safety arrangements and emergency plan.
- This logbook, kept up to date.
- Service certificates for the alarm, emergency lighting and extinguishers.
- Staff training records.

PLAN YOUR YEAR

Your testing calendar at a glance

Tick off each check in this book as you go. "You" means the responsible person or someone you have trained.

How often	Who	What to do
Every day	You	Walk your escape routes. Exits clear, doors unlocked, signs visible. Central battery emergency lighting: check the indicator lights.
Every week	You	Test the fire alarm from a different call point, at about the same time each week.
Every month	You	Emergency lights: short functional test. Extinguishers: visual check. Escape routes, fire doors and signs: logged inspection. Grade D smoke alarms: press test.
Every 3 months	You	Blocks of flats over 11 m: check communal fire doors.
Every 6 months	Competent engineer	Fire alarm inspection and service (between 5 and 7 months after the last one is acceptable). Fire drill: good practice.
Every year	Competent engineer	Extinguisher basic service. Emergency lighting full-duration test. Fire drill (at least once a year). Flat entrance doors (over 11 m). Re-issue resident fire information.
Every 5 years	Competent engineer	Extinguisher extended service (water, foam, powder, wet chemical). Emergency lighting photometric check (BS 5266-1:2025).
Every 10 years	Competent engineer	CO_2 extinguisher overhaul and pressure test.
Regularly	Responsible person	Review your fire risk assessment, and always after any significant change, incident or near miss.

Something wrong?

Do not wait for the next service. Log the fault, make the area safe and call your engineer. The Fire Man: 07540 389424 · info@thefireman.co.uk

YOUR PREMISES

Premises and responsible persons

Keep this page up to date. It is the first thing an inspector or engineer will read.

Premises name	
Address	
Fire risk assessment in place? Yes / No	
Date of current assessment	
Assessed by (name and company)	

Responsible persons and fire wardens

Name	Role	Phone	Email

Fire alarm system

Panel location	
Type of system (circle)	Addressable · Conventional · Wireless · BS 5839-6 Grade A · Grade D (mains smoke alarms)
Category (e.g. L1, L2, L3, M, P)	
Monitored by an alarm receiving centre?	Yes / No
ARC phone / account no.	
Certificate of installation / commissioning issued on	
British Standard installed to	BS 5839-1 · BS 5839-6 · Other: .....
Agreed variations recorded? Yes / No	

Other fire safety equipment

Emergency lighting	Self-contained · Central battery · Rated duration: 1 h / 3 h
Fire extinguishers	Number: ..... Fire blankets: .....
Other (sprinklers, dry riser, AOV, etc.)	

RECORD IT IN FULL

Fire risk assessment record

REVIEW REGULARLY Since 1 October 2023 the law says you must record your whole assessment and who helped you make it.

Keep the full report with this logbook. Review it regularly and always after changes to the building, its use or its people, or after a fire or near miss. Only use an assessor who is competent: ask about their training, experience and any third-party certification.

Date	Full assessment or review?	Assessor name and company	Assessor competence (qualifications, accreditation)	Actions done? Yes / No	Next review due	Responsible person signature

KEEP EVERYONE INFORMED

Sharing fire safety information

Record when you share fire safety information. This shows you have met your duties to co-operate and inform.

Who needs to know?

Other responsible persons in a shared or multi-occupied building: share risks and arrangements.

Residents in buildings with two or more homes: fire safety instructions and fire door information, repeated every year.

A new responsible person when you hand over: pass on the fire risk assessment, records and the name of your assessor.

Employees and contractors risks found, measures in place and what to do in a fire.

Date	Shared with	What was shared	How (letter, email, notice, meeting)	Shared by

PRACTISE YOUR PLAN

Fire drill record

AT LEAST ONCE A YEAR Every 6 months is good practice. Do it more often if staff change often or the risk is high.

Date	Time	Drill led by	People present	Time to evacuate	Problems found and action taken	Signature

KEEP THE WAY OUT CLEAR

Escape routes, fire exits, fire doors and signs

EVERY MONTH Walk every route to the final exit. Answer Yes or No. Any "No" needs action straight away.

Date	Area / exit checked	Routes clear?	Exits open easily?	Fire doors close and latch?	Signs in place?	Comments / action taken	Initials

MONTHLY VISUAL CHECK

How to check your fire extinguishers

EVERY MONTH Takes a minute per extinguisher. You do not need any tools.

✓	**Is it there?** In its marked place, on its bracket or stand.
✓	**Can you see and reach it?** Nothing in front of it. Instructions facing out.
✓	**Has it been used?** Safety pin and tamper seal in place.
✓	**Is the gauge in the green?** Stored-pressure types only. CO_2 has no gauge.
✓	**Any damage?** No dents, rust, leaks, cracked hose or missing parts.
✓	**Can you read the label?** Instructions clear. Service label in date.



Found a problem?

Do not use or move a faulty or discharged extinguisher unless it is in the way. Record it, then call your engineer for a replacement or recharge.

What your engineer does (BS 5306-3:2017)

- **Every year:** basic service by a competent person, with a service label and written report.
- **Every 5 years:** extended service (discharge test and refill) for water, foam, powder and wet chemical.
- **Every 10 years:** CO_2 extinguishers are overhauled and pressure tested, or replaced.
- **Choice and siting:** checked against BS 5306-8:2023, so you have the right type in the right place.

MONTHLY VISUAL CHECK

Fire extinguisher check record

EVERY MONTH One row per extinguisher, or one row per check if all were fine. Tick or write Yes / No.

Date	Extinguisher no. / location	Type	In place and unobstructed?	Pin, seal and gauge OK?	Free from damage?	Action needed	Initials

MONTHLY VISUAL CHECK (CONTINUED)

Fire extinguisher check record

EVERY MONTH One row per extinguisher, or one row per check if all were fine. Tick or write Yes / No.

Date	Extinguisher no. / location	Type	In place and unobstructed?	Pin, seal and gauge OK?	Free from damage?	Action needed	Initials

WEEKLY TEST

How to test your fire alarm

EVERY WEEK BS 5839-1:2025. Same day and about the same time each week, so everyone knows it is a test.

1	**Warn people.** Tell staff and residents a test is about to happen.
2	**Call your monitoring centre.** If your alarm is monitored, put it on test first so the fire service is not called.
3	**Pick the next call point.** Use a different one each week, in order from the call point schedule.
4	**Insert the test key.** Where it goes depends on your call point type. Do not break the glass.
5	**Check it works.** Sounders heard throughout. Panel shows the right zone or device. Keep it short: about a minute.
6	**Silence and reset.** At the panel, as your engineer showed you. Remove the key. The panel should show normal.
7	**End the test.** Tell your monitoring centre and check they got the signal.
8	**Record it.** Write the call point number, the result and any faults in the weekly record.

Fault or false alarm?

- Log it on the fault page.
- Call your engineer. Do not hide or ignore fault lights.
- BS 5839-1:2025 says every false alarm should be investigated.

Your 6-monthly service

- A competent engineer inspects and tests the whole system.
- Between 5 and 7 months after the last visit is acceptable.
- Each visit is recorded on the service page.

Homes and HMOs (BS 5839-6)

Grade A panel systems: test weekly as above. Grade D mains smoke and heat alarms: press each test button at least once a month and record it in the notes or fault pages.



PLAN YOUR ROTATION

Call point schedule

List every call point once (your zone chart or commissioning certificate shows them). Test them in order, one each week.

No.	Location	Zone	No.	Location	Zone
1			25		
2			26		
3			27		
4			28		
5			29		
6			30		
7			31		
8			32		
9			33		
10			34		
11			35		
12			36		
13			37		
14			38		
15			39		
16			40		
17			41		
18			42		
19			43		
20			44		
21			45		
22			46		
23			47		
24			48		

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WEEKLY TEST

Weekly fire alarm test record

EVERY WEEK Use a different call point each week, at about the same time.

Week	Date	Time	Call point no.	Location / zone	Sounders and panel OK?	Faults / comments	Tested by
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							
11							
12							
13							
14							
15							
16							
17							
18							

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WEEKLY TEST (CONTINUED)

Weekly fire alarm test record

EVERY WEEK Use a different call point each week, at about the same time.

Week	Date	Time	Call point no.	Location / zone	Sounders and panel OK?	Faults / comments	Tested by
19							
20							
21							
22							
23							
24							
25							
26							
27							
28							
29							
30							
31							
32							
33							
34							
35							

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WEEKLY TEST (CONTINUED)

Weekly fire alarm test record

EVERY WEEK Use a different call point each week, at about the same time.

Week	Date	Time	Call point no.	Location / zone	Sounders and panel OK?	Faults / comments	Tested by
36							
37							
38							
39							
40							
41							
42							
43							
44							
45							
46							
47							
48							
49							
50							
51							
52							

MONTHLY AND ANNUAL TESTS

How to test your emergency lights

EVERY MONTH BS 5266-1:2025 and BS EN 50172:2024. The monthly test is short. It proves each light comes on when the power fails.

Monthly functional test

1	**Use the test key.** Put the "fish key" in the test switch and turn it. Do not switch off the main lights: that can leave people in the dark.
2	**Walk the building.** Every emergency light and lit exit sign should come on.
3	**Keep it brief.** A few minutes is enough. A long test drains the batteries.
4	**Switch back.** Turn the key back. Check each charge light (usually green) is on again.
5	**Record it.** Note which lights you tested and any that failed.



Annual full rated-duration test

- **What:** every light runs on battery for its full rated time, usually 3 hours.
- **Who:** normally your competent engineer, who records the results.
- **When:** at a quiet, low-risk time. Batteries take up to 24 hours to recharge, so plan for reduced cover afterwards.
- **Every 5 years:** BS 5266-1:2025 adds a check that light levels still meet the design.
- **Central battery systems:** check the indicator panel each day.

> **A light failed?**
> Write down its number and location, report it, and record the date it was fixed. Until then, think about extra measures, such as torches or limiting use of that area after dark.

MONTHLY TEST

Emergency lighting monthly test record

EVERY MONTH Short functional test using the test key.

Month	Date	Lights tested (nos. or "all")	All working ?	Faulty light no. / location	Action taken	Date fixed	Signature
Jan							
Feb							
Mar							
Apr							
May							
Jun							
Jul							
Aug							
Sep							
Oct							
Nov							
Dec							

ANNUAL TEST

Emergency lighting annual full-duration test

EVERY YEAR Full rated-duration test, normally by a competent engineer. Attach the certificate or report.

Date	Rated duration	Lights passed	Lights failed	Action taken / certificate ref.	Engineer and company	Next due

Five-yearly light level (photometric) check

Date	Result	Engineer and company	Next due

LOG EVERY EVENT

Fire alarm faults, false alarms and disablements

Record every fault, false alarm, real fire and any time part of the system is switched off.

Date and time	Zone / device	Event (F, FA, D, Fire)	Cause (if known)	Action taken / engineer called	Date fixed	Signature

Key: F = fault FA = false alarm D = disablement (part of the system switched off) Fire = real fire

COMPETENT PERSON VISITS

Service visits by a competent person

Fire alarm: about every 6 months. Emergency lighting and extinguishers: every year. Keep each certificate.

Date	System (alarm, EL, extinguishers)	Company and engineer	Work done / certificate ref.	Defects still outstanding	Next due	Signature

PEOPLE MATTER

Fire safety training record

Induction, fire warden, extinguisher and evacuation training. Refresh at least once a year.

Name	Role	Training received	Date	Trainer	Refresher due

ANYTHING ELSE

Notes

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